

The Valdosta Daily Times

Saturday
January 9, 1993

Valdosta should see dense morning fog, then a 40 percent chance of rain and possibly a thunderstorm. The high temperature should be in the middle 50s. There's a 60 percent chance of rain and a few thunderstorms tonight. The low temperature should be in the lower 50s. See complete weather details on page 2-A.

Inside

■ ETC: The Valdosta Daily Times' new look television section now has late-night program listings, an enhanced guide to movies and information for more details.

Briefly

■ House Fire: An early morning fire Friday caused \$20,000 damage to a home at 1200 Sunnyside Drive, the Valdosta Fire Department said. Two units responded to the 1200 call-off emergency. The fire is believed to have started in a storage room near a hot water heater, the department said.

No one was injured in the blaze, officials said.

—Doug Boyd

■ Bomb Threat: The Valdosta Fire and Police Departments answered a bomb threat at Valdosta High School Police Department, but to no effect. No bomb was found, but school officials took no chances.

He had somebody call it in about 3:30 this morning," said VHS principal Bill Aldrich. "We evacuated the building. "The students got wet and we put them on buses and sent them home," Aldrich said. He said this bomb threat was the first one at the school in about 10 years.

Police are looking in to the incident. "It's still under investigation," said Capt. Johnny Browning of the Valdosta Police Department, "but to my knowledge we don't have any leads."

—Doug Boyd

Correction

■ MLK Day: An article in Thursday's edition of The Valdosta Daily Times about Martin Luther King Jr. Day activities contained some errors.

The program at Valdosta's Mathis Auditorium with U.S. Rep. Sanford Bishop, D-Columbus, will be at 3 p.m. Sunday, Jan. 17; the program in Whitehead Auditorium at Valdosta State College will be at 7 p.m., Monday, Jan. 18.

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It is the Valdosta Daily Times' policy to correct errors of fact. If you spot an error, please call the editorial department at 363-1100 as possible.

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Teacher's Death Gets Another Look

By DEAN POLING
Times Staff Writer

An unsolved investigation into the June 1990 death of a Pine Grove Primary School teacher is intensifying, Lowndes County Sheriff Ashley Paulk said Friday.

Ultimately, Paulk hopes the investigation will lead to an arrest in the murder of Beverly K. Schappagh, who was found shot to death in her gray 1987 Nissan Sentra parked on the school's property.

"The public had a lot of questions. It was a highly visible case and I promised during

my campaign to look at it real hard," Paulk told The Valdosta Daily Times.

"We hope to sit down with the two detectives who handled the case and see if there is anything that may have been overlooked. Or, possibly, get a new angle on it," Paulk said.

A Lowndes County sheriff's detective, Robert Atkins, will be assigned to the case full time about a week.

"It's not being critical of the previous administration," Paulk said. "But I want to take another look at it."

Ms. Schappagh, 48, was last seen alive,

working at Pine Grove Primary, on the Sunday afternoon of June 17, 1990.

At 6:45 a.m. June 18, a man walking his dog found Ms. Schappagh lying dead in her car.

The Nissan Sentra was parked in the eastern corner of Pine Grove's playground. Next to her body, in the passenger seat, was a 38-caliber handgun. It was registered under Ms. Schappagh's name.

A bullet wound in the left side of her chest was the cause of death, according to Georgia State Crime Lab autopsy reports. The autopsy reports also revealed the suf-

fered a black eye, a bruise on one of her shoulders and both of her knees were scraped.

Though she was buried on Dec. 22, 1990, it would be several months before authorities ruled her death a homicide.

At the time of her death, Ms. Schappagh, described by colleagues as a "very dedicated teacher" had just completed her first year teaching at Pine Grove Primary, located off Bonita Road. She had been employed by the Lowndes County school system since 1979, teaching at Hahira Elementary School for 10 years.

Adult Club Looking At Valdosta

By DEAN POLING
Times Staff Writer

A strip-club representative said Friday his company is interested in two Valdosta-area sites for a possible male-dance club.

However, Jiggs Chambers of Southern Kitchens Inc., which owns the Cafe Erotica near Byron and two similar strip clubs, would not disclose the location of the Valdosta-area sites.

"Valdosta is a good site and has potential for adult-entertainment possibilities," he said. "The establishments offer nude dancing with the dancers in cage-like structures. Chambers said Patrons can give the dancers money but are unable to touch them."

Food is served at the establishments and the only alcoholic beverage served is beer, Chambers said. If a person is driving, they are allowed only two beers. If a person is not driving they are allowed only five beers, he said.

Curran, Greater Lowndes County Planning Commission director, said he hasn't heard from Cafe Erotica officials since they told him they were no longer interested in the Valdosta area last month.

On Wednesday, Chambers said his company had given up. See LOOKING, page 3-A



Tai Chi Exhibition

Sean Denison, Luana Goodwin and Ellen Burns, members of the Taoist Tai Chi Society of Georgia, practice Tai Chi, an ancient Chinese exercise for health, at the old gymnasium at

Valdosta State College Friday afternoon. The exercise is a slow-motion exercise of gentle, relaxing movements that relax and strengthen the body. —Times Photo by Paul Leavy.

Deadline Passes; Iraq Moves Missiles

The Associated Press

NICOSIA, Cyprus — Iraq defiantly rejected an allied ultimatum Friday to remove missiles from southern Iraq, then later reported it began moving the missiles.

A senior Pentagon official in Washington said Iraq moved missiles that were threatening allied jets near the "no-fly" zone, and removed jets from the Al Jahrah air base near the 32nd parallel. He spoke on condition of anonymity.

It was not clear, however, whether the missiles were being moved to meet U.S.-led demands, or simply repositioned. "We're watching the situation very closely," said the Pentagon official.

White House Press Secretary Martin Fitzwiler said the administration was trying to find out whether Iraq was complying with the demand.

Iraq was given a 48-hour deadline on Wednesday by the United States, Britain, France and Russia to remove surface-to-air missiles from southern Iraq, where the

United States had banned use of Iraqi warplanes.

The "no-fly" order was imposed by Washington in August to protect Iraq's rebellious Shiite Muslims from attacks by government forces.

Baghdad's earlier defiance seemed to have increased the possibility the U.S.-led forces might strike Iraq for the first time since the 1991 Persian Gulf War.

Edward Perkins, the U.S. ambassador to the United Nations, said Friday that the deadline for Iraq to act was 5:15 p.m. EST Friday.

The official Iraqi News Agency, which generally closes at 11 p.m. (4 p.m. EST) stayed open until 12:15 a.m. (6:15 p.m. EST) Friday, and then closed down without commenting on the deadline.

U.S. pilots on the USS Kitty Hawk, deployed in the Persian Gulf, reported no Iraqi activity when they patrolled the zone early Friday.

Later in the day, a patrol of 33

planes — nearly double the usual force — made a sweep over southern Iraq, but returned without firing any shots, pilots said, adding that allies were clear over the region.

In Baghdad earlier Friday, Deputy Prime Minister Tariq Aziz told an emergency Cabinet session that "Iraq will not heed the West's ultimatum and will uphold its right to keep its air defense bases where they are."

"Should these bases be attacked, Iraq will certainly respond in kind to the aggression," he said, according to the state-run Iraqi News Agency, monitored in Nicosia.

In recent days, Iraq moved mobile Soviet-made SA-2 and SA-3 surface-to-air missiles into the no-fly zone.

Aziz was quoted as saying the missile batteries were "purely defensive" and had been in place since August.

Iraq's 150-member National Assembly on Friday unanimously approved the Cabinet's decision to

defy the allies' demand, INA reported.

The assembly generally acts as a rubber stamp for government policies.

In another act of defiance, Iraq banned all flights by U.N. weapons inspectors on U.N. aircraft within Iraq, according to an announcement in New York on Friday.

U.N. spokesman Tim Trevar said it was a serious breach of Persian Gulf War cease-fire agreements, which require Iraq to permit international inspection of its weapons facilities.

The Security Council Friday prepared a statement condemning the action, according to a draft released by U.N. diplomats.

The European Community, in a statement from Brussels, Belgium, said the action "bears the full responsibility for the present unacceptable situation."

Iraq and the West have been at odds since the U.S.-led force pushed Iraqi troops from Kuwait in February 1991.

Agencies Receive Drug Seizure \$\$\$

By DEAN POLING
Times Staff Writer

Valdosta and Lowndes County law-enforcement agencies were awarded \$118,000 Friday as part of a federal drug seizure and redistribution program.

Federal Drug Enforcement Agency agent Johnny Thornton of Columbus presented the check for equal distribution to Lowndes Sheriff Ashley Paulk and Valdosta Police Chief Charlie Spry.

On Nov. 7, a Lowndes County deputy stopped an automobile heading southbound near Interstate 75 Exit 6.

The driver was carrying a revoked driver's license and the vehicle's occupants were acting "suspiciously," Thornton said during Friday's press conference.

The deputy found \$2,200 in cash hidden in the vehicle following a search.

A Metro Drug Task Force agent was called to the scene and the money was seized.

A subsequent investigation showed the money was to be used for the "probable cause" of buying drugs and the money was legally seized, Thornton said.

As part of the redistribution program, about 85 percent of drug money seized is given back to local law-enforcement agencies who have assisted or worked a drug investigation.

Spray said the Valdosta Police Department's share of the money is going to pay for its officers' recently acquired semi-automatic weapons.

Paulk said the Lowndes County Sheriff's Department's share of the money will go to purchase portable radio units for deputies and the replacement or repair of some deficient equipment.

The \$118,000 is in addition and unrelated to money allotted each year for their annual budgets.

In this case, "the bad guys are taking the bait," the taxpayers, Spray said, during the press conference.



Elvis Sighting

Deloras Courson, window clerk with the U.S. Post Office in Lake Park, sells sheets of Elvis stamps to customers. Approximately

3,500 stamps in the first five minutes they were on sale. See related story, page 3-A —Times Photo by Jeff Allen.

COMING Sunday:

The Legislature

What Local Reps Are Saying

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